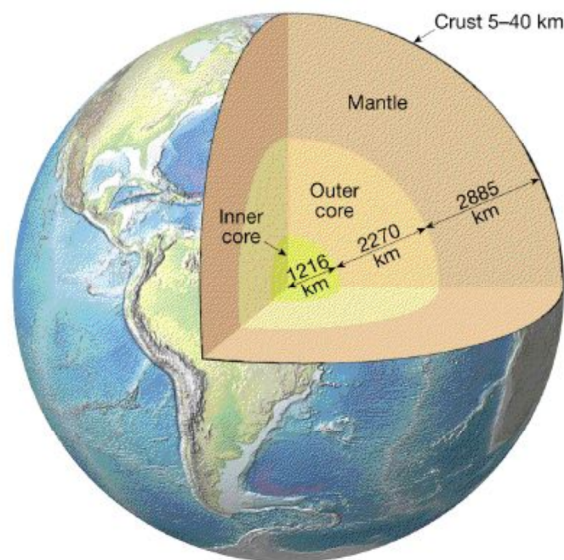


STRUCTURE OF THE EARTH



- | | |
|-------------------|---|
| Crust | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Thin layer of hardened, relatively light rock; from 5 - 40 km thick (30 km average).• Less dense than the mantle (hence it "floats").• Slow movement of the mantle moves the crustal plates, causing earthquakes and volcanoes. |
| Mantle | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Semi-solid (plastic) magma that flows very slowly.• Very hot due to the pressure of the overlying rock.• Makes up over 3/4 of the Earth's volume. |
| Outer Core | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Molten or liquid at around 3 500 °C. |
| Inner Core | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Solid (due to great pressure) and around 5 000 °C.• Made up of mostly iron with nickel. |
| Oceans | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Cover two-thirds of the surface.• Heating of the oceans causes weather in the local area. |
| Atmosphere | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• 78 % nitrogen (N₂), 21 % oxygen (O₂), about 1 % argon (Ar).• Carbon dioxide (CO₂) is only 0.03 % but can cause a greenhouse effect that raises the average temperature of the atmosphere. |
| Soil | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Contains weathered rock material, living organisms and dead remains.• Topsoil contains humus (rotted remains of plants and animals) and contains most animal life. |